

HACKATHON
GRADUATION CLASS OF 2026
NIIT PORT HARCOURT

THEME: Technology for Resilient Nigerian
Communities

DATES: 27TH – 30TH JULY 2026

CHALLENGE STATEMENT

Nigeria's communities face daily challenges caused by unreliable internet connectivity, power instability, limited access to emergency services, financial exclusion, healthcare access gaps, and inadequate digital infrastructure.

These challenges are often more severe in rural areas, riverine communities, growing urban settlements, and during emergencies such as floods, accidents, and security incidents.

Participants are challenged to design and develop a feasible technology solution that helps Nigerian communities continue to access essential services despite these constraints.

KEY QUESTION

How can technology help Nigerians access critical services anytime, anywhere, even when connectivity, power, or infrastructure is limited?

REQUIREMENTS

Solutions should be:

- Practical and deployable within the Nigerian environment
- Affordable and scalable
- Secure and reliable
- Usable by people with varying levels of digital literacy
- Capable of operating in low-connectivity or intermittent-power conditions

Teams may focus on areas such as:

- Emergency response and public safety
- Healthcare access and telemedicine
- Digital payments and financial inclusion
- Smart market and small business solutions
- Flood and environmental alert systems
- Transportation and road safety
- Education access in underserved communities
- Agricultural and rural support services

CATEGORY EXPECTATIONS

Development

Build a working prototype or proof of concept that demonstrates the core functionality of the proposed solution.

Design

Create an intuitive, accessible, and user-friendly interface tailored to the realities of Nigerian users, including low-bandwidth and mobile-first environments.

Infrastructure Engineering (Network/Hardware)

Design the network, connectivity, power, and security infrastructure required to support the solution reliably in urban, rural, or remote communities.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

Criteria	Weight
Feasibility and practicality	30%
Innovation and creativity	20%
User experience and accessibility	15%
Technical quality and security	15%
Infrastructure design and reliability	10%
Presentation and impact	10%